

Syed Zain Gilani | DevOps Engineer

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DevOps Engineer with **5 years** of experience. I have quite robust experience in shell/python scripting to automate complex scenarios. Designing top notch deployment solutions for AI and Fintech operations mainly focussed on **On-prem** solutions and AWS environments.

CORE SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (EKS, ECR, S3, Route53, CloudWatch), Microsoft Azure (Azure DevOps).
- **Microservices & Containerization:** Docker, Podman, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Rancher. (Bare Metal)
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Jenkins, Bamboo, GitHub Actions, Teamcity.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform, Helm Charts, Ansible.
- **Security & Compliance:** SonarQube, Mend.
- **Monitoring & Site Reliability:** Grafana, Prometheus, ELK,
- **Scripting & Databases:** Shell/Bash Scripting, Groovy, MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL
- **Version Control Systems:** GitHub, Bitbucket.
- **Repository Manager:** Nexus, JFrog
- **WebServer:** Nginx, Apache, Traefik (Reverse Proxy, Forward Proxy, SSL)

WORK EXPERIENCE

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Cloud DevOps Engineer

Dec 2023 - Present

- Worked on the migration of Nexus DB from Orient DB to Postgres to ensure high availability for our architecture and minimize the risk of data corruption.
- Shifted our k8s cluster to Rancher RKE2 and Redhat OpenShift architecture for better administration and management of our microservices resulting in 2x fast deployments and 100% automated infrastructure.
- Developed a Power Automate flow for network patch tracking, integrating MS Teams, Outlook, SharePoint, and HTML forms, reducing mail server load by 50% with zero manual intervention.
- Providing support during critical situations and creating RCA for better incident management in future.
- Streamlined environment deployments (DEV, QA, UAT, STG, PROD) using ArgoCD with Kustomize and Helm.
- Designed infrastructure to support HA across datacenters for apps like teamcity, Nexus and Bitbucket
- Part of the disaster recovery task force to recover our infrastructure in case of malware attacks.
- Implemented ELK stack for better logs monitoring/rotation and observability for our containerized applications. We approximately rotate 4.5TB of logs a day to meet our PCI DSS standards.
- Led end-to-end SDLC for Java applications, utilizing TeamCity CI/CD pipelines and Nexus artifact repository to streamline deployments, achieving 1-2 minute production releases.

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DevOps Engineer

Dec 2020 - Dec 2023

- Developed product deployment script in Go, python and bash speeding up the deployment process time by an hour to 10 mins.
- CI/CD pipelines in Jenkins (using Jenkins shared binary feature, groovy syntax and modulated code block approach).
- Containerization of our application written in C++, .NET, Java and python.
- **API** development for fetching the response from our application to get some alerts or signals to perform necessary actions..
- Repositories and libraries scanning through tools like **SonarQube** and **Mend** and its integration with **Jenkins**.
- Additionally, I handle the deployment, maintenance and package management of environments for R, **R-web server**, and **Jupyter**.
- I actively collaborate with our System Integration and Design (SID) and Production Support (PS) teams, providing them with **level 2 (L2) support**. This support encompasses addressing issues related to application failures, disk problems, **programmatic logic in bash/python**, and network-related matters.
- I have conducted multiple support sessions, focusing on **Docker** and various Linux administration tasks, to assist our teams working with clients worldwide, including At&t, Verizon, Optus, UHG, BT, and TurkTelecom.

EDUCATION

NED University of Engineering and Technology Bachelor in Electronics | Batch (2016-2020)
Udacity Nanodegree Cloud DevOps (Bertelsmann Scholarship)

CERTIFICATIONS

CKA (Certified kubernetes Administrator)
AWS Solution Architect Associate (In progress)

PROJECTS

My major project contributions are listed below :

1- Nginx based Proxy server with UI interface

I've created a user-friendly GUI interface where end users simply specify the ports for reverse proxying, and the tool automates the entire process of web server configuration in 5 secs reducing the manual hassle of 30 mins.

2- Nexus Database Migration from OrientDB to Postgres

3- Rancher and Openshift implementation for k8s cluster administration resulting in 10 times faster bootstrapping.

4- Microsoft Power Automate flow to automate the network patches deployment request results in at least 80% reduced manual efforts.

5- Pipelines migration from freestyle to groovy based syntax to ensure better scalability and reusability of same code modules. Also, it ensures changes are 100% tracked in VCS.

6- Developed pipeline as a platform to design other pipelines.

7- Developed grafana dashboard for monitoring of our critical sites/ticket counts and logs observability.

8- Designed and implemented high-availability on-premise infrastructure for critical applications such as Bitbucket, TeamCity, and Nexus, with built-in fault tolerance and cross-data center backup strategies to ensure robust disaster recovery and business continuity.

9- K8s cluster setup on bare metal managing CNI plugin (cilium/calico), loadbalancer (metal LB , nginx ingress , istio , sealed secrets, redis, helm charts, argocd and microservices setup.

10- AZURE AKS Setup :

Automated end-to-end delivery by provisioning and integrating AKS with Azure DevOps pipelines, enabling zero-touch deployments. Built CI/CD workflows to provision AKS, deploy Kubernetes workloads, and push artifacts to JFrog Artifactory on Azure—reducing deployment time by 70% and improving release consistency and scalability.